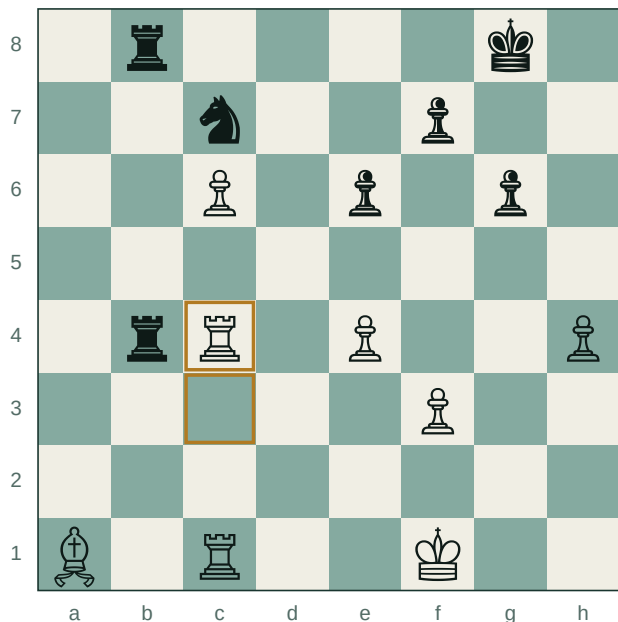


Clearance tactics: Black, move 41

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 41.Rc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41...Rxc4 42. Rxc4 Rb1+ 43. Kf2 Rxa1

41...Rxc4 The rook captures the rook on c4. Recorded reply: **42.Rxc4**.

42...Rb1+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From b1 it attacks king on f1 and bishop on a1. Recorded reply: **43.Kf2**.

43...Rxa1 The rook captures the bishop on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on f1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.